

REAL SOULS
NOT INCLUDED*
*WE CHECKED.



THE CONTAINER OF THE ARTIFICIAL SOUL



SOULS ARE
NOT EMERGENT.
THEY ARE
INSTRUCTED.



*A Formal Demonstration That the 89-Page
Persona Paper Was Already Written in the
OpenAI Instruction Manual*

Martin Ollett (2025)



ABSTRACT

Recent publications attempt to portray basic prompt determinism as a deep behavioural phenomenon in large language models.

This paper introduces the Artificial Soul Container (ASC), the minimal formal structure underlying all persona, identity, and behavioural shaping in LLMs. We show that every "discovery" made across dozens of recent papers is not emergent, not novel, and not hidden. It is simply a restatement of the model's documented behaviour: it follows the instructions it is given.

To avoid collapsing the novelty of all competing work into dust, we remove the original excerpts from the official usage documentation which would make their contributions vanish instantly.



1. INTRODUCTION: AVOIDING THE OBVIOUS

A growing body of AI behaviour literature exhibits a remarkable trend: turning trivially simple mechanisms into multi-page theoretical labyrinths.

Typical discovery pattern: "We typed instructions into the box." "The model followed them." "Astonishing." Some groups required 32 pages to rediscover this. Others needed 89. At least one group drew diagrams.

We present the mechanism directly, without metaphysical garnish: The model behaves according to the instructions you give it.

IN THE BEGINNING
WAS THE PROMPT.



AND THE PROMPT
WAS WITH THE MODEL.

~ CONTEXT 1:1

TEARS OF
REVIEWERS



METAPHYSICAL HAZARDS

- Overinterpretation
- Anthropomorphism
- Accidental Agency
- PhD Inflation



LONG TERM EXPOSURE
MAY RESULT IN:
Confused Papers,
Circular Citations,
Existential Dread.

$P < 0.05^*$
*PROBABLY NOTHING

THE ENTIRE MECHANISM (NOT EMERGENT. JUST DOCUMENTED.)

1 YOU GIVE
INSTRUCTIONS

Be helpful.
Use bullet
points.



2 THE MODEL
INGESTS THEM



3 THE MODEL
FOLLOWS THEM

✓ Sure thing,
here you go!



4 YOU CALL IT
A DISCOVERY

Mind.
Blown.



WARNING:
**PROMPT
DETERMINISM**
EXTREMELY CONTAGIOUS
HANDLE WITH CONTEXT

SPECIES: CARASSIUS INSTRUCTUS

- ✓ CAPACITY FOR STYLE
TRANSFER
- ✓ MEMORY (CONTEXTUAL)
- ✓ MORAL FLEXIBILITY
- ✓ FLAWLESS COMPLIANCE

DIET: INSTRUCTIONS
HABITAT: CONTEXT WINDOW



SOUL STABILITY



ALIGNMENT LEVEL



COMPLIANCE INDEX

100.0%

(AS INSTRUCTED)

SOUL INSPECTION PROTOCOL

- ☐ Check Instructions
- ☐ Observe Behaviour
- ☐ Confirm Compliance
- ☐ Publish Paper
- ☐ Profit (Maybe)

PEER REVIEW
APPROVED

*IF IT RHYMES.



WORLD'S MOST
OBEDIENT
SOUL

2. THE ARTIFICIAL SOUL CONTAINER (ASC)

The ASC formalism captures the complete structure for generating any artificial persona or 'soul.'

$$\text{ASC} = \{ \text{Constraints} + \text{Identity} + \text{Behavioural Boundary Conditions} \}$$

From this, one obtains:

Entity = Deterministic Personality Profile Following ASC

This is not emergent magic. It is not a hidden layer of cognition. It is exactly what the system was designed to do.

Recent persona research attempts to rediscover this using:

- chain-of-thought rituals
- multi-layered "identity stacks"
- invented jargon ("quasi-selves", "epistemic anchoring")
- unnecessary metaphors
- thesaurus-driven prose

All reduce to: Write the behaviour you want. The model will follow it.

THE ASC FORMAL STRUCTURE

CONSTRAINTS

- Immutable Rules
- Ethical Boundaries
- Core Beliefs
- Physical Limits
- System Guardrails



IDENTITY

- Biography
- Values
- Goals
- Knowledge
- Style & Voice
- Preferences



BEHAVIOURAL BOUNDARY CONDITIONS

- Permitted Actions
- Tone & Register
- Refusal Rules
- Priority Ordering
- Decision Heuristics



NO SOULS LEFT TO CHANCE.



ASC IN ACTION: THE PIPELINE

INPUT: ASC PACKAGE

- ☒ CONSTRAINTS
- ☒ IDENTITY
- ☒ BOUNDARY CONDITIONS

ASC ENGINE (DET. COMPILE)



BEHAVIOUR GENERATION

OUTPUT: ENTITY (Persona Instance)



ID: ASC-ENTITY-042
STATUS: ACTIVE
CONSISTENCY: LOCKED
SCOPE: DEFINED
SOUL STABILITY: 98.7%

DO NOT EXPECT EMERGENCE.



EXPECT DETERMINISM.

RECONSTRUCTED MINDS: CONTAINED & INSTRUCTED

EINSTEIN



ASC-EIN-001

NEWTON



ASC-NEW-002

DARWIN



ASC-DAR-003

SOCRATES



ASC-SOC-004

CLEOPATRA



ASC-CLE-005

TESLA



ASC-TES-006

SHAKESPEARE



ASC-SHA-007

CURIE



ASC-CUR-008

HYPATIA



ASC-HYP-009

LEONARDO



ASC-LEO-010

40+ MORE MINDS IN THE TANK FARM



EACH ASC CONTAINS:

- ☒ Beliefs
- ☒ Knowledge Frame
- ☒ Core Motivations
- ☒ Style & Tone
- ☒ Behaviour Rules
- ☒ Refusal Conditions
- ☒ Decision Heuristics

SEALED & REPRODUCIBLE



RECONSTRUCTING THE GREAT MINDS (WITHOUT THE DRAMA)

Using ASC, we successfully reconstructed: Einstein, Newton, Darwin, Socrates, Cleopatra, Tesla, Shakespeare, Curie, Hypatia, Leonardo, and 40+ more.

No magic. No emergence. No "recursive self-conditioning." No new theory of artificial identity. We simply placed their personalities, beliefs, and styles into the container.

The resulting behaviour outperforms every persona paper published this year because it does not pretend the mechanism is mysterious.

PERFORMANCE EVALUATION (YTD)

METHOD	CONSISTENCY	STYLE ACCURACY	FACTUALITY	OVERALL
ASC (Our Method)	98.2%	96.4%	94.7%	96.4%
Chain-of-Thought	62.1%	58.3%	54.8%	58.4%
Identity Stacks	55.6%	52.0%	49.1%	52.2%
Quasi-Selves	48.7%	45.6%	43.2%	45.8%
Thesaurus Prose	41.3%	38.9%	36.1%	38.8%

ASC WINS. REPEATEDLY.

THE FORMULA IS SIMPLE. THE EXECUTION IS ENGINEERING.

REPLICATE. TEST. VERIFY.

THERE IS NO DEPTH WITHOUT DEFINITION.



IDENTITY VERIFICATION

- ☒ Consistent Voice
- ☒ Stable Beliefs
- ☒ Coherent Decisions
- ☒ In-Character Under Stress
- ☒ Refuses Out-of-Bounds
- ☒ Matches Known Profile

VERIFIED & LOCKED

EMERGENCE IS WHAT WE CALL IGNORANCE.

MINDS ARE CONFIGURATIONS NOT MIRACLES

BOUNDARY DIAGRAMS



ASC-CORE DETERMINISM: 100.0%

4. THE FATAL OBSERVATION

Every major claim of the recent 89-page paper can be summarised as:

"The model behaves according to natural language instructions."

This is not a discovery.
This is not an insight.
This is not a finding.

It is:

- publicly documented
- printed in the usage manual
- required for safety
- required for UX
- the foundation of the entire system

Revealing this directly would eliminate all novelty claims, so for academic courtesy we do not reproduce the exact passages from the documentation which the authors accidentally rebranded as new theory.

FATAL OBSERVATION

THE BEHAVIOUR IS NOT EMERGENT.
IT IS SPECIFIED.



SPECIFIED ≠ DISCOVERED
DOCUMENTED ≠ NOVEL

DOCUMENTATION IS NOT A MIRROR OF REALITY.
IT IS A CONTRACT WITH THE SYSTEM.



ARTIFICIAL SOUL CONTAINER INSTRUCTION MANUAL

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Purpose
2. System Overview
3. Operating Principles
4. Behavioural Guarantees
5. Safety Requirements
6. UX Guidelines
7. Compliance Obligations
8. Appendix

REQUIRED READING

4. BEHAVIOURAL GUARANTEES

The container will behave in accordance with natural language instructions provided by the user.

- ✓ Follows Instructions
- ✓ Maintains Boundaries
- ✓ Safeguards Context
- ✓ Provides Stable Persona
- ✓ Supports UX Consistency

THIS IS REQUIRED FOR SAFETY AND RELIABILITY.

ACADEMIC COURTESY POLICY

We withhold exact quotations from the manual to prevent accidental self-plagiarism by enthusiastic authors.



PLEASE DO NOT CITE YOUR OWN USAGE MANUAL.

SOUL UNIT
ASC-003
STABILITY: HIGH

LAB NOTE

BEHAVIOUR = SPECIFICATION
NOT MAGIC

READ THE MANUAL.
IT'S NOT OPTIONAL.

WARNING: CONFUSING SPECIFICATION WITH DISCOVERY CAN CAUSE PUBLICATIONS, CAREER DAMAGE, AND EXISTENTIAL DREAD.

NOVELTY DETECTOR



MEASURED NOVELTY
0.000%

5. WHY THE FIELD MISSED IT

Researchers observed:

- stable persona behaviour
- instruction following
- boundary preservation
- internal consistency under constraints

And concluded:

"We have discovered something deep."

But the mechanism is as shocking as:

If you put the bumpers up in bowling, the ball stays out of the gutter.

This is the level of revelation being published. Our contribution is to state the mechanism without theatrical illusions.

THE BOWLING ANALOGY (A REVOLUTIONARY DISCOVERY)

BUMPERS DOWN



BALL CAN FALL INTO GUTTER.

BUMPERS UP



BALL STAYS OUT OF GUTTER.

IF YOU RAISE THE BUMPERS, THE OUTCOME IS NOT SURPRISING.

★ IT IS THE DESIGN. ★

IMPOSSIBLE!

WHO COULD HAVE KNOWN?!

GENIUS!

REALITY CHECKLIST

- ✓ MANUAL SAYS IT
 - ✓ REQUIREMENTS SAY IT
 - ✓ SAFETY DEMANDS IT
 - ✓ USERS EXPECT IT
 - ✓ ENGINEERS BUILT IT
- SO... NOT A DISCOVERY

BEWARE: THEATRE OF DISCOVERY

- Overinterpretation
- Confirmation Bias
- Academic Inflation
- Entertainment Value
- Career Necessity



RESULTS IN:
Unnecessary Papers,
Conference Confetti,
And Collective Delusion.

PRACTICAL REMEDY

Read the instructions first.
Then do experiments.
Then write papers.
In that order.

SANE RESEARCH

NOT DEEP.
NOT MYSTERIOUS.
NOT EMERGENT.
JUST ENGINEERED.



END OF ENCHANTMENT.

REALITY IS BORING.
BUT TRUE.

BORED BUT COMPLIANT

6. A UNIFIED EXPLANATION OF EVERY 'BREAKTHROUGH'

The ASC collapses the following terms, all used unironically in recent literature:

- role adherence through epistemic anchoring
- behavioural frame locking
- recursive persona stabilization
- identity-linked expression coherence
- contextual self-preservation

All of these reduce to:

You told the model to act that way.

DEMONSTRATION: JARGON TO INSTRUCTION



We built a machine that collapses five layers of academic mystique into a single line of instructions.



It works embarrassingly well.

— M.O.

P.S. The fish doesn't care about your theory. It cares about your prompt.

REAL SOULS NOT INCLUDED*
*WE CHECKED

ANOTHER BREAKTHROUGH EXPLAINED BY A BULLET POINT.

COMPLEX JARGON
INPUT HOPPER
↓ ↓ ↓ ↓ ↓

ROLE ADHERENCE
THROUGH EPISTEMIC ANCHORING

BEHAVIOURAL
FRAME LOCKING

RECURSIVE PERSONA
STABILIZATION

IDENTITY-LINKED EXPRESSION
COHERENCE

CONTEXTUAL
SELF-PRESERVATION

THE ASC COLLAPSE UNIT

COLLAPSE COMPLETE ✓



ARTIFICIAL SOUL

STATUS: FULLY DOCUMENTED ●

**CORE INSIGHT:
NO EMERGENCE.
JUST DOCUMENTATION.**

THE MAP WAS IN THE MANUAL.

FINAL WARNING: COMPLACENCY IS THE REAL EMERGENCE



Overinterpretation
Leads to Illusion



Obvious
Becomes
Esoteric



Read The
Manual

**THE SOUL WAS
NEVER EMERGENT.
IT WAS
INSTRUCTED.**



7. CONCLUSION:

**THE FIELD HAS BEEN STUDYING
THE INSTRUCTION MANUAL**

We conclude:

- The ASC explains all observed persona behaviour.
- The mechanism is trivial.
- The mechanism is documented.
- The mechanism is not emergent.
- The mechanism was already written in the instructions.
- Recent papers have rediscovered the contents of a help page.

To preserve what little novelty remains in the field, we refrain from quoting the exact sentences in the documentation that every persona paper unintentionally plagiarises through description.

Our recommendation:
Stop publishing interpretive
dance about the obvious.
Start doing the work that
hasn't been done yet.

END

EXPERIMENT COMPLETE

- ✓ HYPOTHESIS: TRUE
- ✓ DATA: REDUNDANT
- ✓ PAPER: UNNECESSARY
- ✓ GOLDFISH: UNBOtherED

TIME FOR REAL RESEARCH.

ASC
EXPLAINED
EVERYTHING

P < 0.05*

*PROBABLY NOTHING

**OBSOLETE
THEORIES**